18. Withdraw the needle. Place a piece of gauze over the site of the needle. Swiftly withdraw the needle, following the angle of insertion. Immediately engage the safety device on the needle right after withdrawing from the site. Dispose of the needle into the sharps container.
19. Provide pressure. Directly after removing the needle, use a gauze pad to apply pressure on the venipuncture site at least 5 to 10 seconds before bandaging and to ensure bleeding has stopped. You may allow the patient to apply pressure while you discard items. Look under the gauze pad to determine if the bleeding has stopped. Once bleeding has stopped, proceed to bandage the area.

The Importance of Pressure

Once the venipuncture has been completed, the blood flow must be stopped. The process of stopping the blood is called hemostasis. This is achieved in the body by the creation of clots to halt the blood flow. This is achieved when the blood coagulates. Coagulation is the process by which the body thickens the blood in an area until it becomes a solid, also known as a clot. This clot blocks the blood from moving through an area or halts bleeding on the surface. You aid in the process of hemostasis when you provide adequate pressure on the insertion site after venipuncture.

Performing a Venipuncture With a Butterfly

Some patients may have small, difficult-to-access veins that may require the use of the butterfly to help ensure a successful venipuncture. Choosing most of your supplies, patient positioning, and communication are similar to performing a routine venipuncture, but there are differences in needle preparation and use between the two procedures.

To prepare for a butterfly venipuncture:

1. Review the requisition to determine which tubes you need for the blood test(s) ordered.
2. Gather all the supplies for a routine venipuncture.
3. Identify, position, and prepare your patient as you would for a standard blood draw.

4.4 CHALLENGE

1. Place the following tubes in the proper order of draw.
   A. Red
   B. Green
   C. Light blue
   D. Lavender
   E. Gray

4.4 CHALLENGE KEY

1. C, A, B, D, E. Vacuum tubes must be collected in the proper order of draw to help ensure accurate test results. Proper order of draw for this selection of tubes is light blue, red, green, lavender, gray.